

Word family: **react / reacts / reacted / reacting / reaction / reactive / reactively / reactivity**

Base word: react

Past tense: reacted

Past participle: reacted

-ing form: reacting

Related forms: reaction, reactive, reactively, reactivity

Part of speech: verb (動詞) / related noun and adjective forms (相關名詞及形容詞)

Your sentence:

> “Thanks to him, I now try to think before I **react**...”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **react** means to **respond emotionally or behaviourally to something that happens, especially before or after thinking about it**.

繁體中文： **對某件事情作出情緒、言語或行為上的回應 / 反應**

中文翻譯：

> “...I now try to think before I **react**...”

「.....我現在會先想清楚，再作出**反應**.....」

Here:

react = 對發生的事情作出回應，尤其指情緒或行為上的反應

1. **react = respond to an event/situation (反應) — 作出反應；回應**

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Meaning: To behave, speak, or feel in a particular way because something has happened.

Practice 1 — Original

> “I try to think before I **react**.”

「我會先思考，再作出**反應**。」

Practice 2

> “She **reacted** calmly to the bad news.”

「她對那個壞消息作出了很冷靜的**反應**。」

Practice 3

> “How did he **react** when you told him?”

「你告訴他之後，他有甚麼**反應**？」

react to something = 因為某件事情發生，而在情緒、言語或行為上作出回應

Common:

- * react calmly
- * react badly
- * react quickly
- * react to criticism
- * react to news

2. **react** = respond emotionally rather than thoughtfully (情緒反應) — 情緒化反應；立即反應

React can especially imply an immediate or instinctive response before careful thought.

Practice 4

> “Don’t **react** in anger.”

「不要因為憤怒而立即作出**情緒化反應**。」

Practice 5

> “He tends to **react** before thinking.”

「他往往還沒想清楚就先作出**反應**。」

react = 受到刺激後立即在情緒或行為上回應，可能未經充分思考

This is exactly the nuance in your passage:

> **think before I react**

For strict counting, I would merge this with Meaning 1, but keep the nuance explicit because it

matters in this sentence.

3. **react** = respond physically/biologically to something (身體 / 生物) — 對.....產生反應

A body, organism, or system can **react** to a substance, treatment, environment, or stimulus.

Practice 6

> “Some people **react** badly to certain foods.”

「有些人對某些食物會產生不良**反應**。」

Practice 7

> “The skin may **react** to the chemical.”

「皮膚可能會對這種化學物質產生**反應**。」

react to something = 身體、生物或系統受到刺激後出現某種變化或反應

This is a common domain extension of the general response sense.

4. **react** = undergo a chemical reaction (化學) — 發生化學反應

In chemistry, **react** means substances interact chemically and change into other substances.

Practice 8

> “Hydrogen **reacts** with oxygen.”

「氫會和氧發生**化學反應**。」

Practice 9

> “The two substances **reacted** quickly.”

「這兩種物質很快發生了**反應**。」

react = 兩種或以上物質互相作用，產生化學變化

This is distinct enough to keep separately because the concept shifts from behavioural response to chemical transformation.

5. **react** = oppose a change by moving back toward an earlier position (政治 / 社會 , 較正式)
— 反動 ; 反對變革

In more formal historical or political writing, **react** can mean to respond against change by supporting older conditions or ideas.

Example:

> “Some groups reacted against the reforms.”

= 某些團體反對改革。

However, because this is a political/historical use and is lower priority for your learner-focused database, I would not promote it as a main core meaning here unless that domain is specifically needed.

Related form: **reaction**

Reaction is the noun form and has several major uses.

reaction = response (反應)

Practice 10

> “Her first **reaction** was surprise.”

「她第一個**反應**是驚訝。」

Practice 11

> “The announcement caused a strong **reaction**.”

「這項公告引起了強烈**反應**。」

reaction = 對事件、消息、刺激或情況所作出的回應

reaction = physical/medical response (身體反應)

Practice 12

> “He had an allergic **reaction**.”

「他出現了過敏**反應**。」

reaction = 身體受到某種物質或刺激後產生的生理反應

reaction = chemical process (化學反應)

Practice 13

> “The experiment caused a chemical **reaction**.”

「這個實驗引起了化學**反應**。」

reaction = 物質之間發生的化學變化

Related form: **reactive**

Reactive has two useful meanings.

reactive = responding rather than anticipating (被動反應式) — 反應性的；被動應對的

Practice 14

> “The team was too **reactive** and not proactive enough.”

「團隊太過**被動應對**，不夠主動。」

reactive = 事情發生後才作出回應，而不是事先主動準備

This is especially useful in workplace/strategy English.

reactive = likely to react chemically (化學) — 反應性高的

Practice 15

> “The metal is highly **reactive**.”

「這種金屬具有很高的**反應性**。」

****reactive = 容易與其他物質發生化學反應的****

Related form: ****reactivity****

Practice 16

> “The substance has high chemical ****reactivity****.”

「這種物質具有很高的化學****反應性****。」

****reactivity = 發生反應的傾向或程度****

This is most common in scientific contexts.

Important distinction: ****react vs respond****

****react****

often suggests:

- * immediate response
- * emotional/instinctive response
- * response caused by a stimulus

****respond****

is broader and often sounds more deliberate or neutral.

> “He reacted angrily.”

= 他立即憤怒地反應。

> “He responded carefully.”

= 他仔細地作出回應。

In your sentence:

> ****think before I react****

the contrast strongly suggests avoiding impulsive responses.

Important distinction: **react vs reply**

reply

means answer something said or written.

react

can involve:

- * words
- * actions
- * emotions
- * physical responses

> “She replied to the message.”

= 她回覆訊息。

> “She reacted to the message.”

= 她對訊息作出某種反應。

So **react** is much broader.

Important distinction: **react vs act**

act

means do something.

react

means do something **because of a prior event or stimulus**.

So:

> act = 行動

> react = 因某事而反應

This distinction is central to the word.

Important distinction: **react vs overreact**

Overreact means to react more strongly than the situation reasonably requires.

> “Don’t overreact.”

= 「不要反應過度。」

This is a useful lexical relative, though not part of the base family sweep unless specifically included.

Important distinction: **reactive vs proactive**

reactive

= respond after something happens

proactive

= act in advance to prevent or prepare for something

This is an important modern contrast.

Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

* **react**

* **reacted**

* **reacting**

* **reaction**

* **reactive**

* **reactivity**

Useful constructions include:

* react to something

* react badly

- * react calmly
- * chemical reaction
- * allergic reaction
- * reactive material
- * reactive approach

The Golden Manual says common grammatical constructions and domain extensions should be included while closely related response-types should be merged where the same underlying concept still works.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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react — behavioural/emotional response	因某件事情發生，而在情緒、言語或行為上作出回應
react — physical/biological response	身體、生物或系統受到刺激後產生某種變化或反應
react — chemical	物質互相作用並產生化學變化
reaction	對事件、刺激或物質所產生的回應 / 反應
reactive — behavioural	事情發生後才作出回應，而不是事先主動準備
reactive — chemical	容易與其他物質發生化學反應的
reactivity	發生反應的傾向或程度

For your original sentence

> “Thanks to him, I now try to think before I ****react****...”

The exact meaning is:

****react = 對事情立即作出情緒、言語或行為上的回應****

The contrast is:

> ****think first****
 > then
 > ****react****

So the speaker means:

> ****先冷靜思考，再作反應，而不是衝動地立即回應。****

For your database, I would count ****3 genuinely useful core meanings**** for ****react****:

1. ****respond emotionally or behaviourally to something****
2. ****respond physically/biologically to a stimulus****

3. ****undergo a chemical reaction****

I would merge impulsive/emotional ****react**** into #1, and keep ****reaction, reactive, reactivity**** as family extensions rather than inflate the base-word count.